

Yavuz Selim Kaçmaz

CONTACT INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

University of California, Davis, CA, USA
Ph.D. in Economics, 2024–present

Bogazici University, Istanbul, Turkey
M.A. in Economics, June 2024
B.A. in Economics and History, June 2022

RESEARCH INTERESTS International Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Economic History

PUBLICATIONS

“Unequal Outcomes in Unequal Times: The Distributional Consequences of Turkey’s Unorthodox Policies” (with Tolga Umut Kuzubaş, Islam Tarlacı, and Orhan Torul). *New Perspectives on Turkey*, 2025. 73, pp. 32-51.

Abstract: This paper examines trends in wage, income, and consumption inequality in Turkey from 2002 to 2023, a period marked by unorthodox economic policymaking before and after the COVID-19 pandemic. Using microdata from the Turkish Statistical Institute’s Household Budget Survey and the Survey of Income and Living Conditions, we document several salient distributional patterns. Wage inequality declined steadily over two decades, including during the recent episode of policy experimentation—coinciding with sustained minimum wage hikes and a rising share of university-educated workers. Income inequality also fell, though less markedly, before reversing in recent years due to widening disparities in capital and entrepreneurial income. In addition, consumption inequality rose dramatically during the unorthodox policy period, exceeding income inequality growth and driven primarily by a surge in durable goods consumption among top-decile households. These findings reveal the complex and multi-dimensional distributional consequences of unconventional economic policy in emerging markets and highlight the importance of examining inequality across multiple dimensions when evaluating policy effectiveness.

WORKING PAPERS

“Global Markets at the Dawn of Modern Growth: Evidence from Four Centuries of Grain Prices” (with Kıvanç Karaman)

Abstract: This paper investigates market integration on the eve of the takeoff of modern economic growth in the nineteenth century, and uses the findings to reassess the relationship between markets and growth. To this end, we compile a global city-level dataset of annual grain prices comprising 29,397 observations for 119 cities. The data cover Europe and the Middle East from the sixteenth century, and the Americas and Asia from the eighteenth century to the early twentieth century. We measure market integration along two dimensions, price convergence and price synchronization, and disaggregate trends by domestic versus international integration and across geographic regions. The results indicate that integration gains were already evident in the sixteenth century and were initially concentrated in Northwest Europe, before spreading gradually to other parts of Europe and to North America. In contrast, in Asia, market integration advanced only in the late nineteenth century: international integration rose broadly, while domestic integration improved unevenly and appears to have depended on institutional modernization. Overall, these patterns suggest that the timing and geography of market integration anticipated the takeoff of modern economic growth, supporting the view that integration was a precursor to growth, and not merely a consequence.

WORK IN PROGRESS	“Railroad Expansion and Intergenerational Mobility in the United States” (with Jialin Liu) “Geopolitical Tensions and Trade Realignment: Evidence from the Suez Crisis” (with David S. Jacks and Christopher M. Meissner) “From the Village, to the Village: Teacher Localization and Human Capital in Turkey” (with Koralp Kabal and Murat Güray Kırdar)	
PRESENTATIONS	Economic History Coffee Hour, UC Davis 2025 Bay Area Economic History Workshop, UC Berkeley 2025	
RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIP	Title: Tariffs and Economic Development in the USA: New Evidence from a New Dataset of US Product-Level Tariffs, 1789–Present 2025 Investigators: Christopher M. Meissner Title: Market Integration in the Ottoman Empire, 1550–1914 2022–2023 Investigators: Pinar Ceylan, Kıvanç Karaman, and Şevket Pamuk	
SELECTED TEACHING EXPERIENCE	ECN 110, Global Economic History Spring 2026 ECN 101, Intermediate Macroeconomics Winter 2026 ECN 190, Using Big Data to Solve Economic and Social Problems Winter 2025 EC 504, Macroeconomics II (<i>master’s level</i>) Spring 2024 EC 531, Econometrics I (<i>master’s level</i>) Fall 2023 EC 471, Growth and Development Fall 2022	
HONORS, AWARDS, AND GRANTS	Best First-Year Award, UC Davis 2025 Summer Stipend, UC Davis 2025 Department Fellowship, UC Davis 2024–2025 Murat Sertel Award, Bogazici University 2024 Graduate Scholarship, Turkish Historical Society 2023–2024 Graduate Scholarship, Turkish Education Foundation 2022–2024 Valedictorian in the Economics Department, Bogazici University 2022 Highest-Ranking Double-Major Student, Bogazici University 2022 Alper Orhon Econometrics Award, Bogazici University 2022 Undergraduate Double-Major Scholarship, TUBITAK 2021–2022 Outstanding Success Scholarship, Bogazici University 2016–2022 Scholarship for Turkey’s Top 100, Prime Ministry of the Republic of Turkey 2016–2021 Golden Youth Prize, Türkiye İş Bankası 2016	
COMPUTER SKILLS	Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, L ^A T _E X	